COMPLIANCE

ELEVATED

SOC 2 AUDIT PREP DEMAND

Your largest prospective enterprise client has made SOC 2 Type II certification a hard requirement before signing. Their procurement team wants a complete audit report within two weeks. You have never been through this process before.

SOC 2 Type II assesses the operational effectiveness of security controls over a period (typically 6–12 months) — it cannot be manufactured in two weeks. The five Trust Service Criteria (Security, Availability, Processing Integrity, Confidentiality, and Privacy) map directly onto DevOps practices: access controls, deployment audit logs, change management processes, incident response records, and encryption standards. Organisations that have adopted DevOps practices — IaC, CI/CD with audit trails, automated security scanning, and centralised logging — are often surprised how much SOC 2 evidence they already have. The gap is typically in formal policies, evidence collection tooling, and a dedicated compliance-as-code pipeline. Starting SOC 2 preparation early is the single biggest lever available.

SOC 2 takes 6–12 months to prepare properly. Two weeks is survivable only if the controls were already in place.

TEAM DISCUSSION

Are your access logs, change management records, and security controls documented with continuous evidence collection?